



Module Handbook

Module Code: MGT 1104

Module Name: Introduction to Sustainability Development

2024

1. Introduction to the Module

Module Title: Introduction to Sustainability Development (MGT 1104)					
Year	01	Semester	01	Credit Points	-

1.1 Module Description

The course will provide an overview to sustainability development in the context of UN SDG 2030 outlook in a multidisciplinary manner. Course also provides a broad coverage on the main functional areas of sustainability development such as triple bottom line, green marketing, green architecture and energy conservation. It also aims to develop students' analytical skills and critical approach to understanding the micro-macro impacts of the need to become more sustainable.

1.2 Pre-requisites

N/A

1.3 Teaching Strategy

This module is structured around a series of lectures, case study discussions, relevant activities and video materials. Class participation is an essential component of the design of this course. All students will be expected to engage in class discussions and exercises in order to facilitate the enhancement of their knowledge with regard to the sustainable development goals.

1.4 Intended Learning Outcomes

At the completion of this module, students should be able to;

1. Identify the key competencies for sustainability that allow students to engage constructively and responsibly with today's world
2. Apply the concept of triple bottom line in a business context in multiple fields
3. Explain the path of education and its role in global development
4. The application of green strategies and frameworks to understand important new developments in the global economy
5. Discuss the role of the key stakeholders involved in sustainability and their transformation in a globalized world

1.5 Course Reading Materials

Course Text	Munier, N. (2005). An Introduction to Sustainability: Road to a better future
Supplementary Readings	UNDP. (2021), Sustainable Development Report 2021 - The Decade of Action for the Sustainable Development Goals Martinuzzi, A., & Schönherr, N. (2019). Introduction: The Sustainable Development Goals and the Future of Corporate Sustainability. In Business and the Sustainable Development Goals (pp. 1-17). Palgrave Pivot, Cham. Walker, J., Pekmezovic, A., & Walker, G. (2019). Sustainable development goals: Harnessing business to achieve the SDGs through finance, technology and law reform. John Wiley & Sons. https://www.sdgindex.org/

1.6 Evaluation Strategy:

Students will be evaluated on the basis of group assignments and semester end exam. The weightage given to each of these units is listed below:

- Assessments
 - In class comparative reflection of SDG achievements of 2 countries (15%)
 - Designing a creative poster on a selected SDG (25%)
- Semester End Exam (60%)

1.7 Detailed Schedule of the Course

Session	Topic	Discussion Areas
1 & 2	Introduction to Sustainability	▪ Sustainability defined ▪ The concept of SDG goals ▪ Globalization and the rise of sustainability ▪ Effects of sustainability on corporations
3 & 4	Importance of sustainability (Natural resource depletion, climate change, population explosion and implications)	▪ Tragedy of the Commons ▪ Businesses are required to improve their resource productivity ▪ Balancing the short-term costs for long term benefits ▪ Pressure on firms to take certain actions
5 & 6	Fundamental theories of Sustainability	▪ Triple bottom line ▪ Social upgrading GVC ▪ Stakeholder theory ▪ Circular economy ▪ Smart economy
7, 8, 9, 10	Sustainable development goals (SDG 2030)	▪ Sustainable development framework ▪ Policy advancement and transformation ▪ Implementation of ESD at country level ▪ Tracking issues and trends
11	Consumer behaviour on sustainability issues	▪ Green marketing ▪ Green Gap ▪ Market opportunities for sustainability ▪ Ethical behaviour and public relations of corporations ▪ NGO role in raising awareness ▪ Key industries and global trends

12	Sustainability and policy/decision making	▪ Standards and regulations for sustainable development ▪ Training and development for updated policy frameworks ▪ Civil society organizations, such as consumer associations, have an especially strong role to play in raising awareness, applying pressure on producers, consumers and Governments
13	The role of sustainability in a Sri Lankan context	▪ Government initiatives to mainstream Sustainable Development Goals ▪ Key challenges encountered in the areas of progress (poverty, health & education) ▪ Sustainable development case examples from Sri Lanka
14	Introduction to Business Ethics	▪ Definition of ethics ▪ Definition of business ethics ▪ Role of business ethics in different organizational contexts ▪ Business ethics and the law.
15	Globalization and Business Ethics	▪ A new global space to manage and new local challenges to address ▪ International variety in approaches to business ethics

1.8 Assessment details

Assessment Component I: Group Article

The sustainable Development Goals are considered as a blueprint to achieve a better and more sustainable future for all. Therefore, each individual / organization and country are expected to play an important role in achieving the SDGs.

This assignment is designed to assess your ability to critically analyze and comparatively reflect on the Sustainable Development Goals (SDG) achievements of two countries. It aims to evaluate your research, analytical, and communication skills in the context of global development issues.

Your task is to delve into a variety of sources, including academic papers, official reports, and statistical data, to gather information about the progress and challenges faced by your chosen countries in the context of the SDGs. You will be expected to not only identify and document the achievements and shortcomings but also critically analyze and compare the strategies, policies, and socio-economic factors influencing their progress.

IMPORTANT

*** In order to proceed with the coursework students are expected to form groups of 10 members. All the members should contribute for the assignment. Submission and formatting guidelines for the article will be provided by the module lecturer during lectures.**

Evaluation criteria:

Assessment criteria	Percentage Marks
Comprehensive introduction to the sustainability practices of chosen countries	25%
Critical comparison of SDG achievements of 2 countries	25%
Identification of areas for improvement for 2 countries and recommendations	25%
Organization of the answer (Structure)	10%
Overall teamworking skills	10%
Correct referencing	5%

Assignment Submission Deadline: 08th June 2024

Assessment Component II: Creative Poster

This assignment expects you to prepare a comprehensive SDG related poster highlighting the importance of SDGs and the ways and means on which you can contribute towards achieving them. Your poster presentation is expected to cover the following areas:

1. A brief overview of your respective SDG
2. A detailed synopsis highlighting interesting facts/ tips about your respective SDG
3. A recommendations section highlighting on what potential action that can be taken with regards to achieving your respective SDG

IMPORTANT

****Your module lecturer will be allocating a specific SDG to your respective group during the course of your lectures***

****Further guidance and information on attempting this assignment will be provided to you by your module lecturer***

In order to proceed with the coursework students are expected to form groups of 10 members. All the members should contribute for the poster presentation. Submission and formatting guidelines for the poster will be provided by the module lecturer during lectures.

Evaluation criteria:

Assessment criteria	Percentage Marks
Comprehensive introduction to the chosen SDG	25%
Detailed synopsis of the chosen SDG	25%
Identification of practical recommendations for SDG implementation	25%
Creativity and overall teamworking skills	25%

Assignment submission deadline: 22nd June 2024

1.9 Submission of Assessments

Student should ensure that all assessments are submitted with the completed assignment cover sheet as appropriate to the **N Learn** on/ before the deadline. The assignment cover sheet will be uploaded to the e-learning (N learn) system.

- **Failure to meet the assessment deadlines**

Any option for late assessment submission must be discussed and agreed upon with the module lecturer. Student/s will be compromised with marks (lack of timeliness) otherwise.

- **Scholarly writing and plagiarism**

Student should ensure use of proper referencing throughout all their work.

Accepted referencing guidelines – APA

Failure to acknowledge other's work or coping is viewed as plagiarism and is not allowed. Any issues of plagiarism and any form of academic dishonesty are treated very seriously.

1.10 Module Resources

- **N-Learn**

N-Learn is the main repository for module resources and it is important that you visit the module page regularly.

1.11 Module Delivery

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